



SERENDIB COLLEGE GAMPOLA

HISTORY

2026/History/Gr10&11/T-1/U-1

1. Sources of Studying History

1. What are the two main divisions of historical sources?

2. How are literary sources defined?

3. What constitutes archaeological sources?

4. Into which two categories are the literary sources of Sri Lanka divided?

5. What defines a 'foreign literary source' in the context of Sri Lankan history?

6. Which text is considered the oldest local literary source in Sri Lanka?

7. In approximately which century was the 'Deepawamsa' written?

8. The 'Deepawamsa' contains historical information up to the end of which king's reign?

9. Why was the 'Mahawamsa' composed as a successor to the 'Deepawamsa'?

10. Who was the author of the first part of the 'Mahawamsa'?

11. In which monastery did Mahanama Thero live while writing the 'Mahawamsa'?

12. The first part of the 'Mahawamsa' covers the period from the arrival of Lord Buddha until the end of whose reign?

13. Why is the 'Mahawamsa' considered a highly credible historical source?

14. What is the formal name of the 'Mahawamsa Teekawa' (annotation)?

15. The 'Perakumba Siritha' is an example of which type of ancient literary work?

16. Name one example of a 'Hatan Kawya' used to study the history of Kotte and Kandy.

17. Which literary source focuses on the history of the Buddhist order (Sasana)?

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18. Which text is an important source for political information from the Gampola to Kotte periods?
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19. What was the primary objective of books written from the Anuradhapura era to the beginning of the Kotte era?
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20. List the four factors to consider when using literary sources to form history.
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21. Name two ancient Indian Tamil books that contain information about Sri Lanka.
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22. Which Chinese monk wrote 'Account on Buddhist Kingdom' based on his travels to Sri Lanka?
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23. Who wrote 'An Historical Relation of the Island Ceylon'?
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24. Which Portuguese author wrote a book on Sri Lankan history based on his 18 years of military service there?
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25. What is the name of the book written by the Dutch priest Philippus Baldaeus?
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26. Who wrote the 'Temporal and Spiritual Conquest of Ceylon' while staying in India?
-
27. The term for writings on stones, clay slabs, copper plates, or walls is _____
28. What are 'Brahmi inscriptions' primarily used to record in ancient Sri Lanka?
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29. What is the specific name for rock inscriptions?
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30. What is the specific name for pillar inscriptions?
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31. What is the specific name for slab inscriptions?
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32. What is the specific name for seat inscriptions?
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33. After the 2nd century A.D., what were inscriptions used to record besides religious offerings?
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34. Which Greek-Roman geographer from Alexandria drew an early map of Sri Lanka?
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35. What are the oldest coins found in Sri Lanka called?
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36. Besides 'Kahapana', what other two names are used for the oldest coins in Sri Lanka?
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37. What is the name for the copper coins used during the Polonnaruwa kingdom?
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38. The study of ancient coins is known as _____.
39. Which specific inscription was made by King Keerthi Sri Nisshankamalla in Polonnaruwa?
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40. Where can the famous ancient 'graffiti' epigraphy be found in Sri Lanka?
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41. What is the historical significance of the Panakaduwa copper plate?
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42. Ancient ruins of buildings, stupas, and tanks are collectively known as _____.
43. What specific information can be gained from studying the Sigiriya frescos?
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44. How are 'antiquities' defined in the context of historical sources?
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45. What is the relationship between archaeological sources and literary sources in constructing history?
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46. Which sculpture at the Isurumuni temple represents the gods 'Agni' and 'Parjanya'?
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47. How does studying history contribute to personality development?
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48. Identify one benefit of learning history related to social harmony.
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49. What do various rock-inscribed figures like the Sun, Moon, or bow and arrow represent?
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50. Why is the destruction of antiquities to find 'treasures' a misconception?
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51. How long did Fa-Hsien Thero stay at the Anuradhapura Maha Vihara?
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52. Which Chinese monk recorded information about Sri Lanka in the 7th century A.D. without visiting the country?
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53. What was the title of the book written by Robert Knox based on his 19 years in Sri Lanka?
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54. Under which king was Robert Knox held prisoner in Sri Lanka?
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55. Where was the Panakaduwa copper plate written?
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56. What are the common raw materials of surviving archaeological sources in Sri Lanka?
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57. What is the primary danger to archaeological sources today besides treasure hunting?
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58. How does history help in recognizing one's national identity?
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59. Which type of source is generally considered contemporary to the historical events it records?
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60. The Vallipuram plate is an example of an inscription written on which medium?
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61. What is the importance of foreign sources regarding a country's external affairs?
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62. What is 'Madyakalina Ran Kahawanu'?
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63. Which category of books includes 'Bodhiwamsa' and 'Thupawamsa'?
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64. The 'Indica' by Megasthenis is categorized as which type of source?
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65. Which era's civilization is primarily studied using texts like 'Poojawaliya' and 'Saddharmalankaraya'?
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66. What does the text suggest is the responsibility of the present generation regarding antiquities?
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67. Which source contains the record 'Swasthi Sirisiriwath Apiriyath Lo Ikuth...'?
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68. Which foreign source author reached the rank of captain in the Portuguese army?
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69. Robert Knox escaped Sri Lanka through which port/area?
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70. Which type of inscription is written on stone slabs like an altar or pulpit?
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71. Inscriptions on clay pots and begging bowls are classified as being on which media?
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MCQ-2016

1. To which chronicle was the Tīkā named 'Vaṃsattappakāsini' written?
(1) Dīpavaṃsa (2) First part of the Mahāvaṃsa
(3) Thūpavaṃsa (4) Bōdhivaṃsa
2. The ancient literary, religious informations and chronicles were written in/on
(1) ola leaves. (2) inscriptions. (3) drip-ledge (katāram). (4) gold and copper plates.
3. From his own experience about the information of the Kandyan Kingdom a book was written by
(1) Baldaeus. (2) Ribeiro.
(3) Robert Knox. (4) Fr. Queyiroz.
5. As a citizen, historical knowledge should be used mostly to
(1) study the splendour of ancient Sri Lanka.
(2) use the knowledge in ancient technology through modernization.
(3) refrain from repeating the faults done in the past again.
(4) construct the future by understanding the present through the past experiences.
6. Out of the following, for what reason the archaeological monuments which is a national heritage of Sri Lanka have to be protected?
(1) Because it has to be shown to the future generation.
(2) Because they reflect the Sri Lankan identity.
(3) Because it is important for the development of tourism.
(4) Because it is able to gain a understanding on the activities of the ancient rulers.

MCQ-2018

1. Mahāvaṃsa is specific because of
(1) containing continuous political and religious informations.
(2) being recorded the contemporary events.
(3) being the oldest chronicle.
(4) trustworthiness of the contained information.
2. In archaeological excavations, Chinese, Roman, Arabic and Indian coins have been found from various places of Sri Lanka. The most important fact revealed from these, is that
(1) there was a developed economic pattern in Sri Lanka.
(2) use of coins was popular in Sri Lanka.
(3) there was a developed trade relation between Sri Lanka and foreign countries.
(4) tourists had come to Sri Lanka from various countries of the world.
3. In connection with what period of following, are the sources such as Sandesha Kāvya, Prasasti Kāvya and Hatan Kāvya important in studying the history of Sri Lanka?
(1) From the period of Polonnaruwa to Dambadeniya
(2) From the period of Dambadeniya to Gampola
(3) From the period of Gampola to Kotte
(4) From the period of Kotte to Kandy

MCQ-2019

1. With regard to what subject area that numismatic is studied?
(1) Metal Industry (2) Architecture (3) Pottery Industry (4) Old coins
2. Regarding on what objective that most of the local literary sources which are important to study the history from Anurādhapura period to the beginning of the Kōṭṭe period were written?
(1) Religious (2) Economic (3) Political (4) Social

MCQ-2020

1. What is the educational institution that Ven. Mahanama who wrote the early part of Mahāvamsa lived?
(1) Diksanda Seneviya Pirivena in Anuradhapura
(2) Ālāhana Pirivena in Polonnaruwa
(3) Maurapāda Pirivena in Dambadeniya
(4) Padmawathie Pirivena in Kēragala

MCQ-2021

1. The earliest literary source which provides information on Sri Lankan history is
(1) Mahawamsa. (2) Deepawamsa. (3) Dhatuwamsa. (4) Thupawamsa.
2. By what name are the epigraphs that have been inscribed on rock surfaces called?
(1) Giri Lipi (2) Len Lipi (3) Tam Lipi (4) Puwaru Lipi

MCQ-2022

1. What is the text which has recorded the unbroken history of Sri Lanka?
(1) Dipavamsa (2) Mahavamsa (3) Pujavaliya (4) Rajavaliya
2. From among the following, who, although an invader, is considered to have led a just and law-abiding rule according to Mahavamsa?
(1) Elara (2) Rajaraja
(3) Sri Mara Sri Vallabha (4) Rajendra Chola

MCQ-2023

1. What is the commentary written to the Mahavamsa?
(1) Dipavamsa (2) Vamsatthappakasini (3) Nikaya Sangrahaya (4) Rajavaliya
2. In what name are the oldest coins found in Sri Lanka known?
(1) Kahapana (2) Swastika coins (3) Lakshmi coins (4) Thamba Massa

MCQ-2024

1. From among the following, what is the source that is important to study trade and metal industry in ancient Sri Lanka?
(1) Inscriptions (2) Ruins (3) Monuments (4) Coins
2. From among the following, what is the most prominent information mentioned in Brahmi inscriptions in this country?
(1) Grant of caves to monks (2) Proclamation of government laws to the public
(3) Collection of tax (4) Monastic administration

MCQ-2025

1. What is the literary source written by Mahanama thero which is helpful in studying the history of Sri Lanka?
(1) Deepawamsa (2) Mahawamsa (3) Dhatuwamsa (4) Thupawamsa
2. What is the term used for the inscriptions written on arranged stone pillars?
(1) Len Lipi (2) Puwaru Lipi (3) Tam Lipi (4) Giri Lipi

2019 Q/2

2. (i) State **three** forms of classification according to the nature of creating the inscriptions. (03 marks)
(ii) State **in order** the suitable answer to each of the statements from A to D, selecting from the answers given below within brackets.
A - The first Greek who drew a map of Sri Lanka.
B - The name of the script used in inscriptions during the early Anurādhapura period.
C - The name of the oldest coins found in Sri Lanka from archaeological excavations.
D - The source which state that the minister Isigiri ruled Nakadiva during the reign of Vasabha.
[Megasthenes, Brāhmi, Sanskrit, Ptolemy, Kahāpana, Vallipuram Gold plate, Ridī Massa, Panākaduva Copper plate] (04 marks)
(iii) Explain with reference to **two** factors how inscriptions are important in building the history. (05 marks)
(iv) Describe **three** benefits of studying history. (06 marks)

2020 Q/2

2. (i) Name **three** metals that were used to design coins in the past in Sri Lanka. (03 marks)
- (ii) Name **two** countries to which belonged the foreign coins found in Sri Lanka through archaeological excavations. (02 marks)
- (iii) Name **two** ancient harbours in Sri Lanka from where foreign relations were executed. (02 marks)
- (iv) Describe with reference to **two** factors the importance of coins as a source of studying History. (05 marks)
- (v) Explain with reference to **three** factors the importance of preserving archaeological monuments. (06 marks)

2023 Q/2

2. (i) State **three** foreigners who came to Sri Lanka and wrote accounts of this country. (03 marks)
- (ii) Mention **two** points which should be taken into consideration in the use of literary sources for constructing history. (04 marks)
- (iii) Describe **two** human activities which lead to the destruction of archaeological remains. (05 marks)
- (iv) Explain the importance of studying of history with reference to **three** points. (06 marks)